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van Noort

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(54) **COREOPSIS PLANT NAMED ‘MVNC1902’**

(50) Latin Name: *Coreopsis grandiflora*
Varietal Denomination: **MVNC1902**

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new cultivar of hybrid *Coreopsis* plant named ‘MVNC1902’ that is characterized by its compact plant habit with stems that are similar in length, its long flowering period from late spring to early autumn in The Netherlands, its inflorescences with ray florets that are bright red in color with yellow-orange margins, its abundance of inflorescences that are large in size, its resistance to powdery mildew, its high tolerance to heat and humidity, and its healthy foliage that maintains its bright green appearance.

2 Drawing Sheets

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Botanical classification: *Coreopsis grandiflora*.
Variety denomination: ‘MVNC1902’.

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

This application claims priority to European Community Plant Variety Office (CPVO) Plant Breeder’s Rights Application No. 2022/0407 filed on Feb. 8, 2022, under 35 U.S.C. 119(f), the entire contents of which is incorporated by reference herein. This application is also co-pending with U.S. Plant Patent Applications filed for plants derived from the same breeding program that are entitled *Coreopsis* Plant Named ‘MVNC1823’ (U.S. Plant patent application Ser. No. 17/948,404)*, *Coreopsis* Plant Named ‘MVNC1904’ (U.S. Plant patent application Ser. No. 17/948,459)*, and *Coreopsis* Plant Named ‘MVNC1906’ (U.S. Plant patent application Ser. No. 17/948,477)*.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct cultivar of *Coreopsis* plant, botanically of hybrid origin and known as *Coreopsis grandiflora* ‘MVNC1902’ and will be referred to hereinafter by its cultivar name, ‘MVNC1902’. The new cultivar of *Coreopsis* is an herbaceous perennial grown for landscape and container use.

The new cultivar arose from an ongoing breeding program conducted by the Inventor in Warmond, The Netherlands. The goal of the breeding program is to develop new cultivars of *Coreopsis grandiflora* that are early flowering and have dependable perennial habits, an abundance of flowers, healthy foliage with powdery mildew resistance combined with unique inflorescence coloration.

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‘MVNC1902’ was selected by the Inventor as a seedling in a trial garden in Warmond, The Netherlands in July of 2017. The new cultivar arose from open pollination of unnamed (not patented) seedlings of *Coreopsis grandiflora* in the inventors breeding program. The seeds were pooled after collection and therefore the exact parents are unknown.

Asexual propagation of the new cultivar was first accomplished by stem cuttings in Lisse, The Netherlands in 2021 under the direction of the Inventor. Asexual propagation by stem cuttings and stem cuttings has determined that the characteristics of the new cultivar are stable and are reproduced true to type in successive generations.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

The following traits have been repeatedly observed and are determined to be the characteristics of the new cultivar. These attributes in combination distinguish ‘MVNC1902’ as a unique cultivar of *Coreopsis*.

1. ‘MVNC1902’ exhibits a compact plant habit with stems that are similar in length.
2. ‘MVNC1902’ exhibits a long flowering period from late spring to early autumn in The Netherlands.
3. ‘MVNC1902’ exhibits inflorescences with ray florets that are bright red in color with yellow-orange margins.
4. ‘MVNC1902’ exhibits an abundance of inflorescences that are large in size.
5. ‘MVNC1902’ exhibits resistance to powdery mildew.
6. ‘MVNC1902’ exhibits a high tolerance to heat and humidity.
7. ‘MVNC1902’ exhibits healthy foliage that maintains its bright green appearance.

‘MVNC1902’ can be most closely compared to *Coreopsis grandiflora* cultivar ‘Sonnenkind’ (not patented) and culti-

vars derived from the same crosses; 'MVNC1823', 'MVNC1904', and 'MVNC1906'. 'Sonnenkind' differs from 'MVNC1823' in having a lower resistance to powdery mildew, foliage that is not as healthy, and in producing fewer inflorescences. 'MVNC1823' differs from 'MVNC1902' in having inflorescences with ray florets that are yellow in color with red centers. 'MVNC1904' differs from 'MVNC1902' in having inflorescences with ray florets that are cherry red in color with yellow margins. 'MVNC1906' differs from 'MVNC1902' in having inflorescences with ray florets that are light yellow in color with dark red centers.

STATEMENT REGARDING PRIOR DISCLOSURES BY THE INVENTOR

The Applicant asserts that no publications or advertisements relating to sales, offers for sale, or public distribution occurred more than one year prior to the effective filing date of this application. Any information about the claimed plant would have been obtained from a direct or indirect disclosure from the Inventor. The Applicant claims a prior art exemption under 35 U.S.C. 102(b)(1) for disclosure and/or sales that fall within a one-year grace period prior to the filing date. Publications include but are not limited to listings on websites by Plantipp and Quality Cuttings.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

The accompanying color photographs illustrate the overall appearance and distinct characteristics of the new *Coreopsis*. The photographs were taken of a 1-year-old plant of 'MVNC1902' as grown outdoors in a 17 cm container in Warmond, The Netherlands.

The photograph in FIG. 1 provides a view of the plant habit of 'MVNC1902' in bloom.

The photograph in FIG. 2 provides a close-up view of inflorescences of 'MVNC1902'.

The colors in the photographs are as close as possible with the photographic and printing technology utilized and the color values cited in the detailed botanical description accurately describe the colors of the new *Coreopsis*.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

The following is a detailed description of 1-year-old plants of 'MVNC1902' as grown outdoors in 17 cm containers in Warmond, The Netherlands. The phenotype of the new cultivar may vary with variations in environmental, climatic, and cultural conditions, as it has not been tested under all possible environmental conditions. The color determination is in accordance with The 2015 Colour Chart of The Royal Horticultural Society, London, England, except where general color terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used.

General description:

Blooming period.—Blooms from early late spring to early autumn in the Netherlands.

Plant type.—Herbaceous perennial.

Plant habit.—Clump-forming, compact, bushy, upright leafy flowering stems that are similar in length with inflorescences held above the foliage.

Height and spread.—Reaches an average of 45.5 cm in height and 45.3 cm in width.

Cold hardiness.—At least to U.S.D.A Zone 4.

Diseases and pests.—Resistance to powdery mildew (*Podosphaera macularis*), no susceptibility or resistance to pests has been observed.

Root description.—Fibrous and fine, NN155A in color.

Propagation.—Stem cuttings.

Root development.—An average of 10 days for root initiation, an average of 20 weeks to produce a marketable plant.

Growth rate.—Moderate to highly vigorous.

Branch description:

Branch shape.—Rounded, slightly axially ribbed.

Branch color.—144A.

Branch size.—Main and secondary stems; an average of 16 cm in length and 3 mm in width.

Branch strength.—Very strong.

Branch surface.—Glabrous.

Branch aspect.—Average of 22.5° to vertical.

Branching quantity.—An average of 23 main branches, 5 secondary branches per main stem.

Internode length.—An average of 6.8 cm.

Foliage description:

Leaf division.—Simple.

Leaf margins.—Entire.

Leaf size.—9.2 cm in length, 1.6 cm in width.

Leaf shape.—Lanceolate.

Leaf base.—Long attenuate to decurrent.

Leaf apex.—Bluntly acute to obtuse.

Leaf venation.—Pinnate, color upper surface; 144B, lower surface; 146C.

Leaf attachment.—Upper stem leaves sessile, lower stem leaves petiolate.

Leaf arrangement.—Opposite.

Leaf surface.—Both surfaces smooth, glabrous, margins are sparsely pubescent with short thin hairs; 0.1 mm in length, too small to measure color.

Leaf color.—Young upper surface 143B, young lower surface 143B and 144A, mature upper surface 137A, mature lower surface 147B.

Petioles.—Lower stem leaves; average of 3.7 cm in length, 2 mm in diameter, v-shaped, smooth, glabrous, color; upper surface 143A, lower surface 144A to 144B, margins sparsely pubescent with short thin hairs an average of 1 mm in length and too small to measure color.

Flower description:

Inflorescence type.—Terminal capitulum consisting of ray florets and disc florets.

Lastingness of inflorescence.—Average of 10 days.

Fragrance.—Faint, pleasant.

Quantity of inflorescences.—1 per lateral stem, 115 per plant.

Inflorescence size.—2.2 cm in height, 6.1 cm in diameter, disc diameter 1.1 cm.

Inflorescence buds.—Globular in shape, an average of 9 mm in depth and 9 mm in diameter, dull surface; color; 152A, striped 148A.

Peduncle.—Rounded in shape, moderately strong, held in a vertical angle, an average of 16 cm in length and 2 mm in diameter, 143C in color, smooth, slightly glossy and glabrous surface.

Phyllaries (involucral bracts):

Phyllary number.—2 rows; total of 16, upper row 8, lower row 8.

Phyllary size.—Upper phyllaries; an average of 1.1 cm in length and 4 mm in width, lower phyllaries; an average of 7 mm in length and 2.5 mm in width.

Phyllary color.—Upper phyllaries upper surface; 152B, upper phyllaries lower surface; 144A, 5 upper $\frac{2}{3}$ rd 152B, margins 154B, lower phyllaries upper surface; 137C, lower phyllaries lower surface; 137B to 137C.

Phyllary texture.—Upper phyllaries; smooth, glabrous, 10 lower phyllaries; smooth, glabrous, slightly glossy.

Phyllary apex.—Acute.

Phyllary base.—Cuneate.

Phyllary shape.—Upper phyllaries; ovate, lower phyllaries; narrow ovate. 15

Ray florets: 15

Number.—8.

Shape.—Obovate, rotate.

Size.—An average of 2.9 cm in length and 1.8 cm in width.

Apex.—Cleft into 4 lobes. 20

Base.—Rounded.

Margins.—Entire.

Aspect.—Rotate.

Texture.—Upper surface; matte, glabrous, velvety, 25 slightly carinate, lower surface; very slightly glossy, glabrous, non-velvety.

Color.—When opening upper surface; 46A and 187C, lobes 14A, when opening lower surface; 184A to 184B, lobes 14B, when fully open upper surface; 46A and 185A, lobes 17A, fully open lower surface; 30 176D, lobes 14B.

Disc florets (male and female):

Number.—An average of 110.

Shape.—Tubular.

Base.—Lower 85% fused.

Size.—About 9 mm in length and 2.5 mm in width.

Apex.—Acute.

Surface.—Glabrous, moderately glossy.

Margins.—Entire.

Color.—When opening upper and lower surface; 17A to 17B, mid-section, base 13B, fully open upper and lower surface; 14B, tips 14A, lower half 12D.

Receptacle.—Average of 2 mm in height, 4 mm in diameter, 145B in color.

Receptacle spines.—Linear, 110 per disc floret, soft, narrow acute apex, narrow cuneate base, surface is glabrous, moderately glossy, color; apex 22B, mid-section 1C, base 157D.

Reproductive organs:

Gynoecium.—1 Pistil; an average of 7 mm in length, style; 6.5 mm in length, 145C to 145D in color, stigma; unequal decurrent, 17A in color, ovary; N77B.

Androecium.—5 stamens, filament; 4 mm in length, 145C to 145D in color, anther; linear, 3 mm in length, N199C, pollen; moderate in quantity and 17B in color.

Seed.—Seed development has not been observed.

It is claimed:

1. A new and distinct cultivar of *Coreopsis* plant named 'MVNC1902' as herein illustrated and described.

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FIG. 1



FIG. 2